Module -1 Understanding and Managing Yourself

What is Human Relations?

Human relations is the art of using systematic knowledge about human behavior to improve personal, job, and career effectiveness. The field studies individuals and groups in organizations. Human relations is far more than "being nice to people," because it applies systematic knowledge to treating people in such a way that they feel better and are more productive—such as providing a more relaxed work atmosphere to enhance worker creativity.

Six sources of information that contribute to self-understanding

1. General information about human behavior
2. Informal feedback from people
3. Feedback from superiors
4. Feedback from coworkers
5. Feedback from self-assessment quizzes
6. The Johari Window

1.General Information about Human Behavior

As you learn about people in general, you should also be gaining knowledge about yourself. Therefore, most of the information in this text is presented in a form that should be useful to you personally. Whenever general information is presented, it is your responsibility to relate such information to your particular situation, such as in studying sources of conflict. One such general cause is limited resources; that is, not everyone can have what he or she wants. See how this general principle applies to you. Here is an example involving others: "That's why I've been so angry with Melissa lately. She was the one given the promotion, whereas I'm stuck in the same old job." In relating facts and observations about people in general to yourself, be careful not to misapply the information. Feedback from other people will help you avoid the pitfalls of introspection (looking into yourself).

2.Informal Feedback from People

As just implied, feedback is information that tells you how well you have performed. You can sometimes obtain feedback from the spontaneous comments of others or by asking them for feedback.

3. Feedback from Superiors

Virtually all employers provide employees with formal or informal feedback on their performances. A formal method of feedback is called a performance evaluation. During a performance evaluation (or appraisal), your superior will convey to you what he or she thinks you are doing well and not so well. These observations become a permanent part of your human resources record. Informal feedback occurs when a superior discusses your job performance with you but does not record these observations.

4. Feedback from Co-workers

A sometimes-used practice in organizations is peer evaluations, a system in which teammates contribute to an evaluation of a person's job performance. Although coworkers under this system do not have total responsibility for evaluating each other, their input is taken seriously. The amount of a worker's salary increase could thus be affected by peer judgments about his or her performance. The results of peer evaluations can also be used as feedback for learning about yourself. Assume that coworkers agree on several of your strengths and needs for improvement. You can conclude that others who work closely with you generally perceive you that way.

5. Feedback from Self-Assessment Quizzes

Many self-help books, including this one, contain questionnaires that you fill out by yourself, for yourself. The information that you pick up from these questionnaires often provides valuable clues to your preferences, values, and personal traits. Such self-examination questionnaires should not be confused with the scientifically researched test you might take in a counseling center or guidance department or when applying for a job.

6. Looking at the Self through the Johari Window

A systematic approach to looking at yourself is through a model of communication called the Johari Window, which focuses on self-disclosure. The Johari Window is a grid showing how much information you know about yourself as well as how much other people know about you. (The term Johari came about because the method was created by Joseph Luft and Harry Ingram.)

THE JOHARI WINDOW

Source: "The Johari Window" by Andrew J. DuBrin.

Solicit Feedback →

Give Feedback ↓

	Known to Self	Unknown to Self
Known to Others	**Open Area:** known to self and others	**Blind Area:** blind to self, seen by others
Unknown to Others	**Hidden Area:** open to self, hidden from others	**Unknown Area:** unknown to self and others

- The **open area** consists of information that is known to us and others. Among these readily observable aspects would be hair color, skin color, physical appearance, and spoken communication skills. As a relationship builds we enlarge the open area by revealing more about ourselves. As the open area expands, relationships with others improve—unless you annoy others with too many details about your work and personal life.
- The **hidden area** contains information known to us about ourselves but is hidden from others. Frequent hidden areas are ambitions and dislikes of specific individuals. Over the long term, fewer hidden areas lead

to more openness and closeness in relationships with others. Yet it is prudent to keep some areas hidden, such as describing a strong physical attraction toward your co-worker's or manager's spouse.

- The **blind area** contains information that others are aware of but we cannot see in ourselves in reference to both positive and negative qualities. Many people suffer from thinking that they are not physically attractive, yet others in general have an opposite perception. In the opposite direction, many people perceive themselves to be highly skilled in getting along with other people, yet most people might have an opposite point of view. Feedback from others, if not blocked by defensiveness, will help reduce the blind area. As your blind area decreases, you are likely to enlarge your open area because you will have more accurate data to work with.
- The **unknown area** contains information that you and others do not know about you. It sometimes takes an unusual situation to bring out this unknown information, such as emerging as a leader when a crisis, such as a hurricane, hits your unit of the company.

Benefits of Human Relations

Human relations encompass the interactions and relationships between individuals and groups, particularly in a social or organizational context. Here are some key benefits:

1. Enhanced Employee Morale

Human relations play a crucial role in enhancing employee morale. Strong human relations create a positive workplace culture that enhances employee morale, leading to increased productivity and retention.

2. Increased Productivity

Human relations play a crucial role in increasing productivity in several ways. Investing in human relations ultimately creates a more dynamic and productive work environment, benefiting both employees and the organization as a whole.

3. Better Conflict Resolution

Human relations play a crucial role in effective conflict resolution , in essence, nurturing human relations creates a foundation for addressing conflicts constructively, fostering an environment where all parties feel valued and understood.

4. Improved Employee Retention

Improved human relations within a workplace can significantly enhance employee retention. By focusing on cultivating strong human relations, organizations can create an environment that encourages employees to stay, ultimately benefiting both the individuals and the organization as a whole.

5. Effective Leadership

Effective leadership is deeply rooted in strong human relations. Strong human relations not only enhance communication and cooperation but also create an environment where individuals feel valued and motivated, leading to more effective leadership outcomes.

6. Enhanced Innovation

Human relations play a crucial role in fostering innovation within organizations. Investing in human relations can create an environment where innovation thrives, leading to greater success and adaptability in a rapidly changing landscape.

7. Positive Organizational Culture

Human relations play a crucial role in fostering a positive organizational culture. By prioritizing human relations, organizations can cultivate a positive culture that not only enhances employee well-being but also drives overall success.

8. Customer Satisfaction

Human relations play a crucial role in customer satisfaction, strong human relations create a supportive environment where both employees and customers feel valued, enhancing overall satisfaction.

9. Increased Profitability

Human relations play a crucial role in driving profitability for businesses. Fostering strong human relations not only enhances workplace culture but also directly impacts productivity, customer satisfaction, and ultimately, profitability. Investing in employee relationships is a strategic move for long-term financial success.

How work and personal life influence each other?

Work and personal life influence each other in a number of specific ways, as shown below,

1. **Job satisfaction enhances life satisfaction.**
   The satisfaction you achieve on the job contributes to your general life satisfaction. Conversely, if you suffer from chronic job dissatisfaction, your life satisfaction will begin to decline. Career disappointments have been shown to cause marital relationships to suffer. Frustrated on the job, many people start feuding with their partners and other family members.

2. **An unsatisfying job can damage physical health.**
   An unsatisfying job can affect physical health, primarily by creating stress and burnout. Intense job dissatisfaction may even lead to heart disease, ulcers, intestinal disorders, and skin problems. People who have high job satisfaction even tend to live longer than those who suffer from prolonged job dissatisfaction. These benefits may be attributed to better physical health and passion for life. Finding the right type of job may thus add years to a person's life.

3. **Relationships with people on and off the job influence each other.**

   The quality of your relationships with people at work and in personal life influence each other. If you experience intense conflict in your family, you might be so upset that you will be unable to form good relationships with coworkers. Conversely, if you have a healthy, rewarding personal life, it will be easier for you to form good relationships on the job. People you meet on the job will find it pleasant to relate to a seemingly positive and untroubled person.

4. **Certain skills contribute to success in both work and personal life.**

   Certain skills contribute to success in both work and personal life. For example, people who know how to deal effectively with others and get things accomplished on the job can use the same skills to enhance their personal lives. Similarly, people who are effective in dealing with friends and family members and who can organize things are likely to be effective supervisors.

5. **Workers who achieve a good balance between the demands of work and family life are likely to be more productive and satisfied.**

   Workers who achieve a good balance between the demands of work and family life are likely to be more productive and have more job satisfaction.4 A repeated research finding related to this idea is that work can interfere with family life, and family life can interfere with work. The person who cannot attend a social event with friends and family because of work demands is likely to be frustrated. At the same time, a person who cannot work late into the night to meet a work deadline because of an event with friends and family is likely to be frustrated. When a person experiences conflict between work and family life, in the short run, the person will have a decrease in subjective (feelings of) well-being. However, many people seem to adjust to work–family conflict over time and experience fewer problems with subjective well-being.

Self-esteem

Self-esteem refers to the regard or respect that one has for oneself. It encompasses beliefs about one’s worth, abilities, and overall value as a person. High self-esteem often correlates with confidence and a positive outlook on life, while low self-esteem can lead to feelings of inadequacy, self-doubt, and negative self-image. It's shaped by various factors, including personal experiences, relationships, and societal influences. Building healthy self-esteem is important for mental well-being and overall quality of life.

Components of Self esteem

Self-esteem consists of several key components:

1. **Self-Acceptance**: Recognizing and embracing one's own worth and identity without undue self-criticism.
2. **Self-Confidence**: Believing in one's abilities and judgments, which affects how individuals approach challenges and tasks.
3. **Self-Respect**: Valuing oneself and maintaining personal standards that contribute to a sense of dignity.
4. **Self-Efficacy**: The belief in one's capability to achieve goals and succeed in various tasks, influencing motivation and persistence.
5. **Social Comparison**: How individuals perceive themselves in relation to others, which can impact self-esteem positively or negatively.
6. **Body Image**: The perception of one's physical appearance, which can significantly affect overall self-esteem.
7. **Achievements and Competence**: Recognizing personal accomplishments and skills contributes to a positive self-view.
8. **Support Systems**: Relationships with family, friends, and communities can bolster or diminish self-esteem based on the quality of these interactions.

Each of these components interacts with one another, shaping overall self-esteem.

How to develop self-esteem

Part of understanding the nature of self-esteem is to know how it develops. Self-esteem comes about from a variety of early life experiences. People who were encouraged to feel good about themselves and their accomplishments by family members, friends, and teachers are more likely to enjoy high self-esteem. The basis for a healthy level of self-esteem grows out of a secure attachment to a parent. Self-esteem later in life can be weak if a parent is inconsistently supportive or lacks empathy and concern for the child. Self-esteem is enhanced if the parent is emotionally supportive toward the child even when the child does something wrong, such as spilling a glass of diet soda on a beige carpet.

As just implied, early life experiences play a key role in the development of both healthy self-esteem and low self-esteem, according to research synthesized at the Counselling and Mental Health Center of the University of Texas. Childhood experiences that lead to healthy self-esteem include the following:

- Being praised
- Being listened to
- Being spoken to respectfully
- Getting attention and hugs
- Experiencing success in sports or school

In contrast, childhood experiences that lead to low self-esteem include the following:

- Being harshly criticized
- Being yelled at or beaten
- Being ignored, ridiculed, or teased
- Being expected to be "perfect" all the time
- Experiencing failures in sports or school
- Often being given messages that failed experiences (losing a game, getting a poor grade, and so forth) were failures of one's whole self

Consequences of self esteem

No single factor is as important to career success as self-esteem, as observed by psychologist Eugene Raudsepp. People with positive self-esteem understand their own competence and worth and have positive perceptions of their abilities to cope with problems and adversity.

Positive Consequences

The right amount of self-esteem can have many positive consequences, as described next.

1.Career Success

A major consequence of having high self-esteem is that you have a better chance of attaining career success, as mentioned at the beginning of this section, and supported by long-term research.

2.Organizational Prosperity

The combined effect of workers having high self-esteem helps a company prosper. Self-esteem is a critical source of competitive advantage in an information society. Companies gain the edge when, in addition to having an educated workforce, employees have high self-esteem, as shown by such behaviors as the following:

- Being creative and innovative
- Taking personal responsibility for problems
- Feeling independent (yet still wanting to work cooperatively with others)
- Trusting one's own capabilities
- Taking the initiative to solve problems

3.Good Mental Health

One of the major consequences of high self-esteem is good mental health. People with high self-esteem feel good about themselves and have positive outlooks on life. One of the links between good mental health and self-esteem is that high self-esteem helps prevent many situations from being stressful. Few negative comments from others are likely to bother you when your self-esteem is high. A person with low self-esteem might crumble if somebody insulted his or her appearance.

4.Profiting from Negative Feedback

Although people with high self-esteem can readily shrug off undeserved insults, they still profit well from negative feedback. Because they are secure, they can profit from the developmental opportunities suggested by negative feedback. Workers with high self-esteem develop and maintain favorable work attitudes and perform at high levels.

5.Serves as a Guide for Regulating Social Relationships

Another consequence of self-esteem is that you can use it as a guide in regulating social relationships. According to Mark Leary, self-esteem provides a gauge of performance during social interactions: "Self-esteem rises and falls, acting as an internal barometer of how well you're faring, telling you to fix this problem here, and helping you understand that you don't have to worry about it there."

Potential Negative Consequences

High and low extremes in self-esteem can create problems for individuals, as described next.

1.Exaggerated levels of self-esteem can lead to narcissism.

Self-esteem can elevate to the level where the individual becomes self-absorbed to the point of having little concern for others, leading to narcissistic attitudes and behaviors. **Narcissism** is an extremely positive view of the self, combined with limited empathy for others. Quite often, extreme narcissism can hamper success because the narcissist irritates and alienates others in the workplace.

2.Envying too many people.

A potential negative consequence of low self-esteem is envying too many people. If you perceive that many individuals have much more of what you want and are more worthwhile than you, you will suffer from enormous envy. To decrease pangs of envy, it is best to develop realistic standards of comparison between you and other people in the world.

3.Poor romantic relationships when self-esteem is low.

Low self-esteem can have negative consequences for romantic relationships because people with self-doubts consistently underestimate their partners' feelings for them. People with low **self-respect** distance themselves from the relationship—often devaluing their partner—to prepare themselves for what they think will be an inevitable breakup

Importance of self esteem

Self-esteem is crucial for various aspects of life, including mental health, relationships, and overall well-being. Here are some key reasons why it matters:

1.Confidence

Self-esteem and confidence are closely related, but they're not the same thing. Self-esteem refers to how you value yourself and your sense of worth, while confidence is about your belief in your abilities to succeed in specific situations. Nurturing self-esteem can lead to increased confidence, empowering you to pursue your goals and face challenges with a more positive outlook.

2.Healthy Relationships

Self-esteem plays a crucial role in building and maintaining healthy relationships. Self-esteem can enhance emotional intimacy and connection, making relationships more fulfilling and resilient.

3.Goal Achievement

Self-esteem plays a crucial role in goal achievement. It acts as a foundation for pursuing and achieving goals, creating a positive feedback loop where success further boosts self-esteem.

4.Adaptability

Healthy self-esteem can enhance adaptability in several ways. When individuals believe in their worth and abilities, they're more likely to embrace change, take risks, and view challenges as opportunities for growth. This confidence allows them to navigate new situations more effectively and bounce back from setbacks. Essentially, self-esteem fosters a positive mindset that makes it easier to adjust to life's ups and downs.

5.Leadership Skills

Self-esteem plays a crucial role in developing leadership skills. It lays the foundation for the qualities and behaviors that are integral to effective leadership.

6.Career Advancement

Self-esteem plays a crucial role in career advancement. It can significantly impact how individuals navigate their careers, opening doors to advancement and opportunities.

Self-confidence

Self-confidence refers to the belief in one’s own abilities, qualities, and judgment. It involves having a positive yet realistic view of oneself and feeling capable of handling challenges. Self-confidence can influence how you approach tasks, interact with others, and cope with setbacks. It’s important for personal growth, decision-making, and overall well-being. Building self-confidence often involves setting and achieving goals, overcoming fears, and developing a strong sense of self-worth.

Sources of self confidence

Research by college professors and psychological consultants George P. Hollenbeck and Douglas T. Hall suggests that our feelings of self-confidence stem from five sources of information.

The first source is the *actual experience,* or *things we have done*. Having done something before and having succeeded is the most powerful way for you to build self-confidence. If you successfully inserted a replacement battery in your watch without destroying the watch, you will be confident in making another replacement.

The second source of self-confidence is the *experiences of others,* or *modeling.* You can gain some self-confidence if you have carefully observed others perform a task, such as resolving conflict with a customer. You might say to yourself, “I’ve seen Tracy calm down the customer by listening and showing sympathy, and I’m confident I can do the same thing.”

The third source of self-confidence is *social comparison,* or *comparing yourself to others.* If you see other people with capabilities similar to your own perform a task well, you will gain in confidence. A person might say, “If that person can learn how to work with enterprise software, I can do it also. I’m just as smart.”

The fourth source of self-confidence is *social persuasion,* or *the process of convincing another person.* If a credible person convinces you that you can accomplish a particular task, you will often receive a boost in self-confidence large enough to give the task a try. If the encouragement is coupled with guidance on how to perform the task, your self-confidence gain will be higher. So the boss or teacher who says, “I know you can do it, and I’m here to help you,” knows how to build self-confidence.

The fifth source of self-confidence is *emotional arousal,* or *how you feel about events around you and manage your emotions.* People rely somewhat on inner feelings to know if they are self-confident enough to perform the task. Imagine a person standing on top of a high mountain ready to ski down. However, he or she is trembling and nauseous with fear. Contrast this beginner to another person who simply feels mildly excited and challenged. Skier number one has a self-confidence problem, whereas skier number two has enough confidence to start the descent. (Have your emotional sensations ever influenced your self-confidence?)

The more of these five sources of self-confidence are positive for you, the more likely your self-confidence will be positive.

Importance of self confidence

Having self-confidence is about having a realistic understanding of your abilities and limitations. It’s neither overestimating nor underestimating yourself. Self-confident individuals are aware of their strengths and weaknesses, which allows them to make informed decisions and handle life’s ups and downs with grace.

The three reasons why self-confidence is important are:

1. Communication

Self-confidence enables you to express your thoughts and ideas effectively. It allows you to articulate your views with clarity and conviction, making it easier for others to understand and engage with you.

2. Career Advancement

In the professional world, self-confidence is a valuable asset. It can help you take on challenging projects, lead teams, and present your ideas with authority. This, in turn, can lead to career advancement and greater opportunities.

3. Personal Growth

Self-confidence plays a pivotal role in mental health by fostering resilience and empowering individuals to navigate life's challenges with a sense of assurance. When you believe in your abilities, you're more likely to step out of your comfort zone, learn new skills, and set ambitious goals.

Self-confidence is not just a personal trait; it's a tool that can transform your interactions with the world, boost your career, and pave the way for personal development.

However, what might boost one person's self-confidence might have a different effect on another. Understanding the intricate web of factors that affect self-confidence is the first step toward self-improvement.

Factors That Affect Self-Confidence

Self-confidence flourishes when you believe in yourself. Self-confidence is a dynamic trait influenced by various internal and external factors. Understanding these factors can help you navigate the path to building and maintaining self-confidence.

1. Internal Factors

Self-perception: How you view yourself, your abilities, and your worth significantly affects your self-confidence. A positive self-perception can boost confidence, while a negative self-perception can undermine it.

Belief system: The beliefs you hold about your capabilities and potential have a profound impact on your self-confidence. Believing in your ability to learn and grow fosters self-confidence.

Past experiences: Past successes and failures play a role in shaping your self-confidence. Achievements can enhance your belief in your abilities, while setbacks may lead to self-doubt.

2. External Factors

Feedback: Feedback from others, whether positive or negative, can influence your self-confidence. In the workplace, feedback and social connections can significantly impact one's confidence. Constructive feedback can boost confidence, while harsh criticism can erode it.

Social support: The presence of a supportive network of friends, family, and colleagues can bolster your self-confidence. A strong support system provides encouragement and positive reinforcement.

Societal norms: Societal expectations and norms can impact self-confidence. Some societal standards may create unrealistic or unattainable ideals that can affect your self-perception.

Awareness of these internal and external factors is the first step in understanding self-confidence.

Characteristics of High and Low confident people:

High-confidence individuals typically exhibit the following characteristics:

1. **Self-Assurance**: They believe in their abilities and decisions.
2. **Positive Body Language**: They maintain good posture, make eye contact, and engage actively.
3. **Resilience**: They handle setbacks and failures constructively.
4. **Proactive Communication**: They express their thoughts and ideas clearly and assertively.
5. **Willingness to Take Risks**: They embrace challenges and step out of their comfort zones.
6. **Open to Feedback**: They seek and appreciate constructive criticism for growth.

In contrast, low-confidence individuals may display:

1. **Self-Doubt**: They often question their abilities and decisions.
2. **Closed Body Language**: They may avoid eye contact and appear physically withdrawn.
3. **Avoidance of Challenges**: They tend to shy away from new experiences or risks.
4. **Difficulty in Communication**: They may struggle to express themselves clearly and assertively.
5. **Sensitivity to Criticism**: They may take feedback personally and feel discouraged by it.
6. **Fear of Failure**: They might be hesitant to try new things due to the fear of not succeeding.

These traits can vary widely among individuals, and confidence can fluctuate based on circumstances.

Self-Motivation

Self-motivation refers to the internal drive to take action and achieve goals without needing external incentives or encouragement. It involves setting personal objectives, maintaining focus, and pushing oneself to overcome obstacles. Self-motivated individuals often cultivate discipline, resilience, and a strong sense of purpose, enabling them to stay committed to their pursuits even in challenging circumstances.

How Needs and Motives Influence Motivation

According to a widely accepted explanation of human behavior, people have needs and motives that propel them toward achieving certain goals. Needs and motives are closely related. ***A need*** is an internal striving or urge to do something, such as a need to drink when thirsty. It can be regarded as a biological or a psychological requirement. A person who is deprived in some way (such as not having enough fluid in the body) is motivated to take action toward a goal. In this case, the goal might be simply getting something to drink.

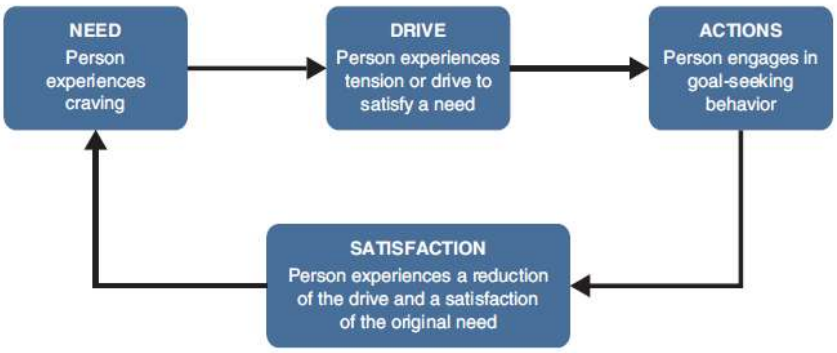
A discussion of needs often triggers a discussion of the difference between needs and wants. A need is essentially a craving or urge that must be satisfied to maintain your equilibrium. In contrast, ***a want*** refers to more of a luxury—something you would like to have but is not necessary to keep your system balanced. A need is a more technical concept than is a want.

Here is an example of the difference between a need and a want: Visualize yourself jogging in 90-degree weather. Suddenly your need for water surfaces, so any old fountain water will satisfy your physiological craving. But at the same time, you want a prestige brand of flavored bottled water to drink. You don't need the bottled water, you want it.

A motive is an inner drive that moves you to do something. The motive is usually based on a need or desire and results in the intention to attain an appropriate goal. Because needs and motives are so closely related, the two terms are often used interchangeably. For example, "recognition need" and "recognition motive" refer to the same thing.

The Need Theory of Motivation

The central idea behind need theory is that unsatisfied needs motivate us until they become satisfied. When people are dissatisfied or anxious about their present status or performance, they will try to reduce this anxiety. This need cycle is shown below,



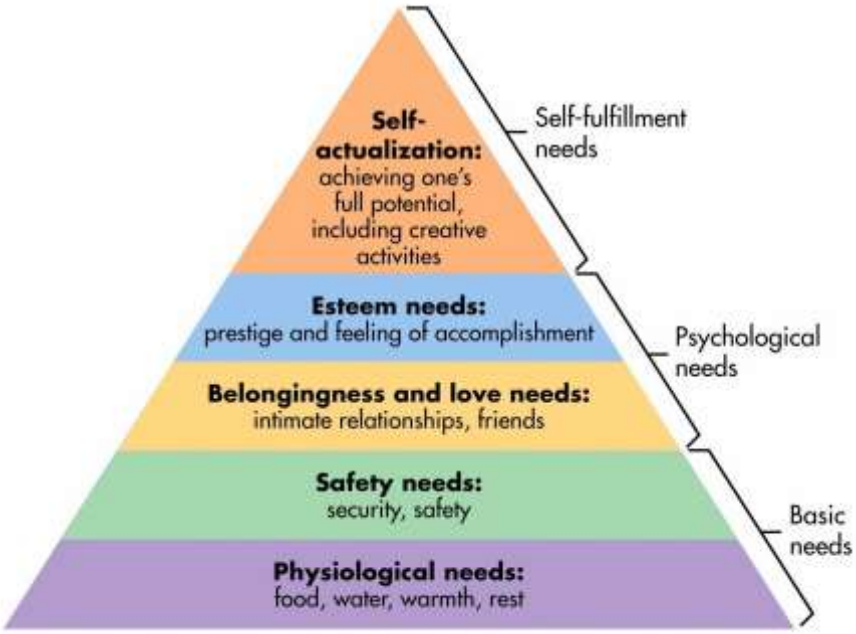
Assume that you have a strong need or motive to achieve recognition. As a result, you experience tension that drives you to find some way of being recognized on the job. The action you take is to apply for a position as the team leader of your group: Being appointed as team leader would provide ample recognition, particularly if the team performs well. You are appointed to the position, and for now, your need for recognition is at least partially satisfied as you receive compliments from your co-workers and friends. Once you receive this partial satisfaction, two things typically happen. Either you will soon require a stronger dose

of recognition, or you will begin to concentrate on another need or motive, such as achievement. In either case, the need cycle will repeat itself. You might seek another form of recognition or satisfaction of your need for power.

For example, you might apply for a position as department manager or open your own business. Ideally, in this former situation, your boss would give you more responsibility, which could lead to more satisfaction of your recognition need and to some satisfaction of your need for achievement.

Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs

Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs is a psychological theory proposed by Abraham Maslow in 1943. It suggests that human motivations are organized in a hierarchy, typically depicted as a pyramid with five levels:



1. **Physiological Needs**: These are the basic survival needs, such as food, water, shelter, sleep, and warmth. They are fundamental for human existence.
2. **Safety Needs**: Once physiological needs are met, individuals seek safety and security. This includes physical safety, financial stability, health, and well-being.
3. **Love and Belongingness Needs**: After safety, social needs emerge. This level encompasses relationships, friendships, family connections, and a sense of belonging to groups.
4. **Esteem Needs**: This level involves self-esteem, respect, recognition, and the desire for achievement. It includes both self-worth and the esteem one receives from others.
5. **Self-Actualization Needs**: At the top of the hierarchy, self-actualization refers to realizing personal potential, pursuing creativity, personal growth, and self-fulfilment.

Maslow believed that individuals must satisfy lower-level needs before they can focus on higher-level ones. The model is often used to understand human motivation, personal development, and psychological health.

Techniques used by managers to motivate employees and workers

Managers can employ a variety of techniques to motivate employees and enhance workplace productivity. Here are some effective strategies:

1. **Recognition and Rewards**: Acknowledging individual and team accomplishments through praise, awards, or bonuses can boost morale and motivate employees to maintain high performance.
2. **Goal Setting**: Establishing clear, achievable goals helps employees understand expectations and gives them something to strive for. Using SMART (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound) criteria can be particularly effective.
3. **Career Development**: Offering opportunities for training, skill development, and career advancement can motivate employees to invest in their roles and the company.
4. **Empowerment**: Giving employees autonomy in their tasks and decision-making fosters a sense of ownership and responsibility, leading to increased motivation.
5. **Positive Work Environment**: Creating a supportive, inclusive, and engaging workplace culture can enhance employee satisfaction and motivation.
6. **Feedback and Communication**: Regular, constructive feedback and open communication channels help employees feel valued and informed, which can increase motivation.
7. **Team Building Activities**: Organizing team-building exercises can enhance camaraderie and collaboration among employees, making them more motivated to work together.
8. **Work-Life Balance**: Encouraging a healthy work-life balance through flexible schedules or remote work options can lead to increased job satisfaction and motivation.
9. **Incentive Programs**: Implementing performance-based incentive programs can motivate employees to exceed expectations by aligning their efforts with rewards.
10. **Mentorship and Coaching**: Providing mentorship opportunities can help employees feel supported and motivated as they navigate their careers.

By tailoring these techniques to the specific needs and preferences of employees, managers can foster a more motivated and productive workforce.

Self-motivation

Self-motivation refers to the ability to inspire and drive oneself to take action, pursue goals, and overcome obstacles without needing external incentives or encouragement. It involves setting personal goals, maintaining a positive mindset, and having the discipline to stay focused and committed. Self-motivated individuals are often proactive, resilient, and capable of managing their time and resources effectively to achieve what they desire.

Examples for self-motivated people who succeeded in life

Here are some notable examples of self-motivated individuals who achieved significant success:

1. **Oprah Winfrey**: Overcoming a challenging childhood, Oprah became a media mogul and philanthropist, known for her talk show and influence in various fields.
2. **Elon Musk**: The founder of SpaceX and Tesla, Musk has consistently pursued ambitious goals in technology and space exploration, driven by his vision for the future.
3. **J.K. Rowling**: After facing numerous rejections, Rowling persisted in her efforts to publish the Harry Potter series, which became a global phenomenon.
4. **Richard Branson**: The founder of the Virgin Group, Branson has launched over 40 businesses, demonstrating relentless drive and a willingness to take risks.
5. **Howard Schultz**: The former CEO of Starbucks, Schultz transformed the company into a global brand, motivated by a vision of creating a unique coffee culture.
6. **Malala Yousafzai**: An advocate for girls' education, Malala has shown incredible courage and determination, becoming the youngest Nobel Prize laureate.
7. **Steve Jobs**: Co-founder of Apple, Jobs was known for his intense focus and passion for innovation, leading to ground-breaking products and a cultural shift in technology.
8. **Michelle Obama**: As First Lady of the United States, Michelle used her platform to advocate for education and healthy living, inspiring many through her initiatives and writing.

These individuals exemplify how self-motivation, resilience, and a clear vision can lead to remarkable achievements.

Goal setting

A goal is a specific objective or target that a person aims to achieve. It provides direction and motivation, helping to focus efforts and resources toward accomplishing a desired outcome. Goals can be short-term or long-term and can relate to various aspects of life, such as personal growth, career, education, health, or relationships. Setting clear and measurable goals often helps individuals track their progress and stay committed to their aspirations.

Goal setting is the process of identifying specific objectives you want to achieve and creating a plan to reach them. It involves defining clear, measurable, and achievable goals, which helps to focus efforts and resources, track progress, and maintain motivation. Effective goal setting often includes setting short-term and long-term goals, ensuring they are realistic and aligned with personal values and aspirations.

Importance of goals

Goals play a crucial role in various aspects of life for several reasons:

1. **Direction and Focus**: Goals provide a clear path, helping you prioritize your actions and decisions. They act as a roadmap, guiding you toward your desired outcomes.
2. **Motivation**: Having specific goals can boost motivation. They create a sense of purpose and urgency, driving you to take action and persevere, especially during challenges.
3. **Measurement of Progress**: Goals allow you to measure your progress and achievements. This feedback can help you stay on track and make necessary adjustments along the way.
4. **Accountability**: In remote working environments, managers find it easier to assess employee performance with questions about meeting milestones or targets. Goal-setting is not a one-time exercise; it requires constant follow-up that includes evaluation of performances to check progress. This creates accountability within the team, as each member is aware of and responsible for their output.
5. **Enhanced Performance**: Setting goals can improve performance by encouraging you to push your limits and strive for excellence. They can lead to increased productivity and efficiency.
6. **Increased Confidence**: Achieving goals, even small ones, can build self-esteem and confidence. Each success reinforces your belief in your abilities, motivating you to tackle bigger challenges.
7. **Clarity and Decision-Making**: Goals help clarify your values and priorities, making it easier to make decisions that align with your long-term vision.
8. **Resilience**: Working towards goals can foster resilience, as you learn to navigate setbacks and stay committed to your objectives.
9. **Fulfillment and Satisfaction**: Achieving goals can lead to a sense of fulfillment and satisfaction, contributing to overall well-being and happiness.

In summary, goals are essential for personal growth, success, and a meaningful life, providing structure and purpose to our actions.

Characteristics of Goals

When setting up your goal plan, one of the most important things to think about is whether the goals that you are creating are setting you up for success. But what makes a good goal? How do you know if you're goal setting effectively? We recommend creating SMART goals which incorporate these 5 characteristics of a good goal. SMART stands for Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Realistic, and Timely.

This goal-setting approach is popular in the world of business and entrepreneurship, and for good reason! It will allow you to focus on setting achievable goals for yourself that you can put into action to propel you and your small pet business forward.

1.Specific

One key factor to consider is whether you are creating a well-defined goal. Vague goals fail to describe exactly what you are hoping to achieve, which can make it impossible to determine if you have achieved them or not. You should try to answer the five 'W' questions: Who, What, Where, When, and Why.

Vague or general goal: I want to grow my website traffic.

Specific, well-defined goal: I want to use social media and paid advertising to increase my website traffic by 10% by the end of Q1 2023 to boost the number of people entering my sales funnel.

2.Measurable

To set a measurable goal, you will need to focus on the numbers and data associated with your goal and track your progress toward success. For online businesses, this often revolves around analytics and insights. Not only will it allow you to make sure you are moving forward toward your set goal, but it will also allow you to determine the exact moment that you achieve it.

Looking at the example of a well-defined goal above, the measurable component would be the determination of website traffic such as the number of pageviews each day and what percentage that is of your original traffic. Did you reach your 10%?

3.Achievable

This is an important part of setting a goal, and yet it's one that is often overlooked. Setting goals that aren't achievable is the opposite of setting yourself up for success. Not only is it frustrating when you don't reach your goals, but it can discourage you and hold you back from success moving forward.

After you have written down your specific and measurable goal, take a step back and ask yourself if you have the time, resources, and capabilities to achieve it. Be honest!

If the answer is "no, it's not achievable," that may not mean it's completely off the table. Often our goals ARE achievable, just not in the timeframe that we originally associated them with. Consider whether you can bring your goal down into smaller steps with the intention being to complete the first step in that original time period. This could set you up to achieve the goal eventually by working up to it.

4.Relevant

Does your goal align with where you are trying to grow your business? As a small pet business owner, your time is limited. Spending that time working towards a goal that isn't going to help with your larger business plan isn't the best use of your time. Instead, make sure that the goals you are setting are relevant to the big picture. For example, if you are working on increasing product sales, your goal should help in some way to move forward with that in mind.

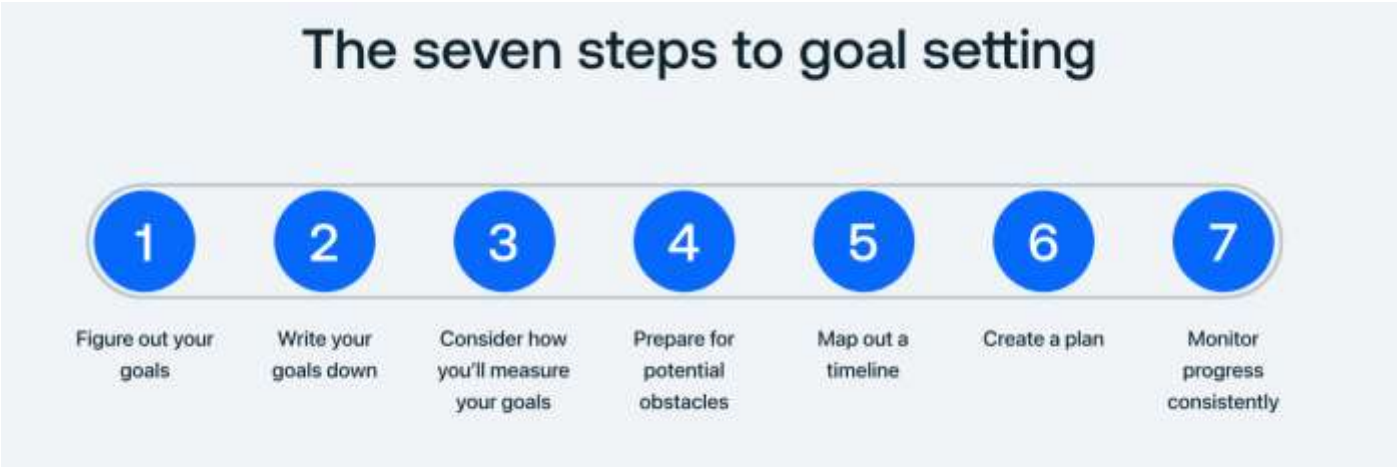
5.Timed

To track and assess your goal and determine if you did or did not meet it, you need to set a timeline. This means having a clear start and end date. Having a set deadline isn't designed to create stress. But it does help to create a sense of urgency as well as make your goal measurable.

If you set a goal to "grow your Instagram followers", the lack of a deadline makes assessing it a challenge. How do you know if you grew "enough" to hit your goal? Many goals require a lot of work upfront in order to eventually reach the desired result. But you need to have a deadline to know if you actually reach your goal. It's easy to get caught up in the work without seeing a result otherwise.

Process of Goal Setting

A goal-setting process is a vital tool for organizations seeking to drive measurable progress and achieve desired outcomes. It offers a clear path to defining goals and outlining the steps necessary to attain these. As a result, fostering clarity, motivation, and accountability among employees.



Step 1: Figure out your goals

The first step of an actionable goal setting process is figuring out what you want to achieve, why you want to achieve it, and when you want to achieve it. If you're unsure where to start, use your company's comprehensive mission statement as a base. This way, you can work on setting goals for employees and teams based on your company's priorities.

Step 2: Write your goals down

Once you've settled on your goals, the second step involves writing these down. Putting pen to paper and writing out your goals cements them as tangible, improves clarity, and gives you time to reflect on why you chose them. When putting your goals in writing, it's essential to take note of your language: avoid using perhaps, may, or might, as these can affect how attainable you perceive these goals to be.

Step 3: Consider how you'll measure your goals

After solidifying your goals in writing, the third step of the goal setting process is figuring out how you'll measure goal progress. Achieving your goals requires you to know precisely what success looks like, and most of the time, this requires a quantifiable approach, such as using KPIs or OKRs.

Step 4: Prepare for potential obstacles

You must be prepared to encounter challenges when working to achieve your goals. As challenges can come in many forms (e.g., knowledge, people, skills, or context), you need to take a bird's-eye view and consider all grounds when anticipating goal setting obstacles. Once you've pinpointed possible hurdles, dig deeper into their root causes. Thinking of these beforehand can help you address and tackle goal setting issues before they emerge, resulting in more confidence throughout the goal setting process.

Step 5: Map out a timeline

The fifth step of goal setting is to create a timeline for your goals. This timeline should clearly outline the tasks, milestones, and deadlines you need to tick off to achieve your goals. A visual timeline of everything you need to accomplish can help you create realistic expectations for achieving your goals while making the more significant goal seem more digestible.

Step 6: Create a plan

After establishing your goal setting timeline, you need a plan for approaching these goals. With a plan in place, you become aware of what you need to do to accomplish the goals you've set out for your business. You can start creating a plan by first emphasizing the daily habits you must get into to gain momentum. After this, pan out to the weekly, monthly, and quarterly steps you need to take to overcome obstacles and successfully realize your goals.

Step 7: Monitor progress consistently

A study by Censuswide and Geckoboard revealed that tracking your progress increases the likelihood of obtaining your goals, with companies that track progress hitting their goals almost twice as much as companies that don't. As such, you need to engrain weekly or monthly goal progress reviews into your goal setting process. Doing so can also help you remain organized and focused while allowing you to reflect on your goal performance.

Factors to be considered while setting the goals

When setting goals, it's important to consider several factors to ensure they are effective and achievable. Here are some key considerations:

1. **Specificity**: Goals should be clear and specific. Instead of a vague goal like "get fit," aim for "exercise three times a week."
2. **Measurability**: Define how you will measure progress. This helps track achievements and stay motivated.
3. **Achievability**: Ensure that the goal is realistic given your resources, time, and circumstances. Setting unattainable goals can lead to frustration.
4. **Relevance**: The goal should align with your broader life objectives and values. It should matter to you personally.
5. **Time-bound**: Set a deadline for achieving your goal to create urgency and encourage consistent effort.
6. **Resources**: Consider what resources (time, money, skills) you have or need to achieve the goal.
7. **Potential obstacles**: Identify possible challenges you may face and think about how you will overcome them.
8. **Flexibility**: Be prepared to adjust your goals as circumstances change. Flexibility can help you stay on track even when things don't go as planned.
9. **Support system**: Consider who can help you achieve your goal. Support from friends, family, or mentors can be invaluable.
10. **Personal motivation**: Reflect on why the goal is important to you. A strong personal motivation can drive commitment and perseverance.

Taking these factors into account can help you set goals that are both motivating and attainable.

Emotional intelligence

Emotional intelligence is the "ability to accurately perceive your own and others' emotions; to understand the signals that emotions send about relationships; and to manage our own and others' emotions."

Need for emotional intelligence

Emotional intelligence (EI) is crucial for individuals for several reasons:

1. **Improved Relationships**: EI helps in understanding and managing one's own emotions, which leads to better communication and stronger relationships with others.
2. **Enhanced Self-Awareness**: By recognizing your emotions, you can better understand how they influence your thoughts and actions, leading to more mindful decision-making.
3. **Better Stress Management**: High EI enables individuals to cope with stress more effectively, as they can regulate their emotional responses and maintain a positive outlook.
4. **Empathy**: Being emotionally intelligent fosters empathy, allowing individuals to understand and respond to the feelings of others, which is essential for teamwork and collaboration.

5. **Conflict Resolution**: EI equips individuals with skills to navigate conflicts more effectively, promoting constructive dialogue and understanding rather than escalation.
6. **Leadership Skills**: Emotionally intelligent leaders can inspire and motivate their teams, fostering a supportive and productive work environment.
7. **Increased Resilience**: Understanding emotions helps individuals bounce back from setbacks and adapt to changes more readily.
8. **Personal Growth**: EI encourages continuous self-reflection and personal development, helping individuals align their actions with their values and goals.

In essence, emotional intelligence contributes to personal well-being and the ability to thrive in social and professional settings.

Key Components of Emotional Intelligence

Four key factors included in emotional intelligence are as follows:

1. Self-awareness. The ability to understand your moods, emotions, and needs as well as their impact on others. Self-awareness also includes using intuition to make decisions you can live with happily. (A person with good self-awareness knows whether he or she is pushing other people too far.)
2. Self-management. The ability to control one's emotions and act with honesty and integrity in a consistent and acceptable manner. The right degree of self-management helps prevent a person from throwing temper tantrums when activities do not go as planned. Effective workers do not let their occasional bad moods ruin their day. If they cannot overcome the bad mood, they let co-workers know of their problem and how long it might last. (A person with low self-management would suddenly decide to drop a project because the work was frustrating.)
3. Social awareness. Includes having empathy for others and having intuition about work problems. A team leader with social awareness, or empathy, would be able to assess whether a team member has enough enthusiasm for a project to assign him or her to that project. Another facet of social skill is the ability to interpret nonverbal communication, such as frowns and types of smiles.(A supervisor with social awareness, or empathy, would take into account the most likely reaction of group members before making a decision affecting them.)
4. Relationship management. Includes the interpersonal skills of being able to communicate clearly and convincingly, disarm conflicts, and build strong personal bonds. Effective workers use relationship management skills to spread their enthusiasm and solve disagreements, often with kindness and humor. (A worker with relationship management skill would use a method of persuasion that is likely to work well with a particular group or individual.)

Consequences of High and Low Emotional Intelligence

Demonstrating good emotional intelligence is impressive because it contributes to performing well in the difficult arena of dealing with feelings. A worker with good emotional intelligence would engage in such behaviors as (a) recognizing when a coworker needs help but is too embarrassed to ask for help, (b) dealing with the anger of a dissatisfied customer, (c) recognizing that the boss is facing considerable pressure also, and (d) being able to tell whether a customer's "maybe" means "yes" or "no." and (e) **Emotional contagion** is the automatic and unconscious transfer of emotions between individuals based on cues the other person observes. The contagion takes place because people have a tendency to mimic and synchronize the facial expressions, sounds, postures, and movements of another person. As a result of the mimicking, the second person experiences the emotion of the first person.

A synthesis of a large number of studies indicated that for high-emotional-labor jobs (those that require positive emotional displays), emotional intelligence contributes to good performance. Also of note, emotional intelligence makes a contribution beyond cognitive intelligence and personality traits when the job calls for emotional display. A sales manager who had the responsibility of firing up the sales force would therefore benefit from having good emotional intelligence. For jobs with low emotional content, such as an accounts payable specialist, emotional intelligence would typically make a very small contribution to job performance. Recent research suggests that emotional intelligence is associated with good job performance because emotional intelligence includes conscientiousness, self-efficacy, and extraversion.

Attitudes

Attitudes are evaluative statements—either favorable or unfavourable—about objects, people, or events. They reflect how we feel about something. When you say "I like my job," you are expressing your attitude about your work.

Components of Attitudes

The following are three components of attitude:

1.Cognitive Component
2.Affective Component
3.Behavioral Component

1.Cognitive Component

This component includes the beliefs an individual has about a certain person, object, or situation. The belief that "discrimination is wrong" is a value statement. Such an opinion is the cognitive component of an

attitude. Learned beliefs, such as “you need to work long hours to get ahead in this job”, lead to attitudes that have an impact on behavior in the workplace.
The cognition component of an attitude reflects a person’s perceptions or beliefs. Cognitive elements are evaluative beliefs and are measured by attitude scales or by asking about thoughts. The statement “I believe Japanese workers are industrious,” reflects the cognitive component of an attitude. The cognitive component sets the stage for the more critical part of attitude- its affective component.

2. Affective Component

This component refers to the person’s feelings that result from his or her beliefs about a person, object, or situation. A person who believes that hard work earns promotions may feel anger or frustration when he or she works hard but is not promoted.

The affective component becomes stronger as an individual has more frequent and direct experience with a focal object, person, or situation. ‘Affect’ is the emotional component of an attitude. It refers to an individual’s feelings about something or someone.

Statements such as “I like this” or “I prefer that” reflect the affective component of an attitude. Affect is measured by physiological indicators such as galvanic skin response (changes in electrical resistance of skin which indicate emotional arousal) and blood pressure.

These indicators show changes in emotions by measuring physiological arousal. If an individual is trying to hide his or her feelings, this might be shown by a change in arousal.

3. Behavioral Component

This component refers to the individual’s behavior that occurs as a result of his or her feelings about the focal person, object, or situation. An individual may complain, request a transfer, or be less productive because he or she feels dissatisfied with work.

The behavioral component of an attitude refers to an intention to behave in a certain way toward someone or something. The behavioral component is the intention to behave in a certain way towards an object or person.

For example, our attitudes towards women in management may be inferred from an observation of the way we behave toward a female supervisor. We may be supportive, passive, or hostile depending on our attitude. The behavioral component of an attitude is measured by observing behavior or by asking a person about behavior or intentions.

Job Attitudes

Job attitudes refer to the feelings, beliefs, and perceptions that individuals have toward their jobs and the workplace. These attitudes can significantly influence job performance, job satisfaction, organizational commitment, and overall well-being.

Key components of job attitudes include:

1. **Job Satisfaction**: How content an individual is with their job, including aspects like work tasks, environment, and relationships with colleagues.
2. **Organizational Commitment**: The degree to which an employee feels attached to and identifies with their organization, influencing their willingness to stay with the company.
3. **Work Engagement**: The level of enthusiasm and dedication an employee has towards their work, which can affect productivity and performance.
4. **Job Involvement**: The degree to which individuals identify with their job and consider it a central part of their self-image.

Positive job attitudes can lead to higher performance and lower turnover rates, while negative attitudes may result in disengagement and increased absenteeism. Understanding and addressing job attitudes is crucial for improving workplace dynamics and employee satisfaction.

Importance of Positive Attitudes

Positive attitudes have always been the foundation of effective human relations, as reflected in the writings of Dale Carnegie, the pioneer of the popular (rather than scientific) approach to human relations. He emphasized such truisms as “Don’t criticize, condemn, or complain,” and “Talk in terms of the other person’s interests.”

A worker who consistently maintains a *genuine* positive attitude will accrue many benefits as shown below,

1.Customer Service

A positive attitude in customer service not only enhances individual interactions but also contributes to the overall success and reputation of the business.

2.Less Absenteeism

A positive attitude plays a crucial role in reducing absenteeism and fostering a positive workplace culture can significantly contribute to lower absenteeism rates, enhancing overall organizational performance.

3.Tardiness

A positive attitude can significantly impact how one deals with tardiness, both personally and in a broader context. A positive attitude not only helps individuals manage their tardiness more effectively but also promotes a more understanding and collaborative atmosphere among those affected by it.

4.Less turnover

A positive attitude in the workplace is crucial for reducing employee turnover. Promoting a positive attitude through leadership, training, and a supportive culture can significantly contribute to lower turnover rates and a more stable workforce.

5.Higher Productivity

A positive attitude plays a crucial role in enhancing productivity. Incorporating a positive attitude can significantly impact individual performance and overall organizational productivity.

Happiness

Happiness can be considered a byproduct of having the various components of life working in harmony and synchrony. To understand this approach, visualize about six gears with teeth, spinning in unison. As long as all gears are moving properly, a state of equilibrium and fluid motion is achieved. Similarly, imagine that life has six major components. The exact components will differ among people.

For most people, the components would be approximately as follows:

1. Work and career

2. Interpersonal life, including loved ones and romantic life

3. Physical and mental health

4. Financial health

5. Interests and pastimes, including reading, surfing the Internet, and sports

6. A spiritual life or belief system, including religion, science, or astrology

When you have ample satisfactions in all six spheres, you achieve happiness.

However, when a deficiency occurs in any of these six factors, your spheres are no longer in harmony, and dissatisfaction or unhappiness occurs.

Yet sometimes, if you are having problems in one sphere, satisfaction in the other spheres can compensate temporarily for a deficiency in one. For the long range, a state of happiness depends on all six spheres working in harmony. In short, the theme of this text surfaces again: Work and personal life are mutually supportive.

Source: "THE SPHERES-OF-LIFE MODEL OF HAPPINESS" by Andrew J. DuBrin.

The Keys to Happiness

If you are aware of known contributors to happiness, you might be able to enhance your happiness. Fortunately there is some consistency in information about what makes people happy. Here we summarize and synthesize a wide range of research and opinion on the keys to happiness.

1.Give High Priority to the Pursuit of Happiness

Having the intention or goal of being happy will enhance your chances of being happy. Discover what makes you happy and make the time to pursue those activities, as spending time doing what you enjoy contributes directly to happiness. You need to put intentional effort into becoming happier. If people think about happy life events every day for three days, within four weeks they are happier than they were before they started this routine. If you are going through a particularly unhappy period, you may have to stretch to think of a few happy life events

2.Seek Satisfactory Outcomes from Decisions Rather than Looking to Maximize Gain

If you hope for reasonable outcomes from your decisions, rather than attempting to typically want the best possible outcome, you will be happier. Experimenters, led by psychology professor Barry Schwartz, have found that satisficers tend to be happier than maximizers. A maximizer is much like a perfectionist who is never satisfied with a decision outcome. In contrast, a satisficer is happier with his or her decision and does not worry about the possibility of not having made the ideal choice.

3. Develop and Maintain Friendships with Happy People

Positive interactions with people facilitate being happy. To quote Daniel Gilbert, "If I had to summarize all the scientific literature on the causes of human happiness in one word, that would be 'social.'(Social in this context means interaction with people, not exclusively social media on the Internet.) Evidence indicates that getting connected to happy people is especially important for improving a person's own happiness.

Furthermore, people with the most social connections, including friends, spouses, neighbours, and relatives, were also the happiest.

4. Develop a Sense of Self-Esteem

High self-esteem enables one to love and be loved. Developing a good self-image leads to the self-esteem required for loving relationships. An early contributor to the importance of thinking positively about oneself was Émile Coué, a French psychologist. In the twentieth century he taught that mental health could be achieved by repeating the sentence, “Every day and in every way I’m becoming better and better.”40 An important part of developing self-esteem is to not want financial success more than other things. Insecure people seek society’s approval in the form of purchasing consumer goods and accumulating investments. (In this way, the person might be admired by others.)

5. Appreciate the Joys of Day-to-Day Living

A major obstacle to happiness is hedonic adaptation, the tendency to adapt to exciting new aspects of life as routine after a while.41 Imagine that a person who wants a luxurious lifestyle finally purchases a fiftieth-story condominium penthouse overlooking a harbour. At first, the view is breath-taking, yet after a while, looking at the harbor becomes routine. To overcome the hedonic adaptation, you therefore have to learn to appreciate the joys of day-to-day living. The essence of being a happy person is to savor what you have right now.

6.Be Fair, Kind, and Helpful, and Trust Others

The Golden Rule is a true contributor to happiness. It is also important to practice charity and forgiveness. Helping others brings personal happiness. Knowing that you are able to make a contribution to the welfare of others gives you a continuing sense of satisfaction and happiness. Related to fairness and kindness is trust of others. Happy people have open, warm, and friendly attitudes.

7.Learn to Cope with Grief, Disappointment, Setbacks, and Stress

To be happy, you must learn how to face problems that occur in life without being overwhelmed or running away. It is also important to persevere in attempting to overcome problems rather than to whine or engage in self-pity. Once you have had to cope with problems, you will be more able to appreciate the day-to-day joys of life.

8.Energize Yourself through Physical Fitness

Engage in regular physical activity, such as dancing or sports that make you aerobically fit. Whether it is the endorphins released by exercise, dopamine released by the excitement, or simply the relaxed muscles, physical fitness fosters happiness. Physical fitness also contributes to happiness because it helps us minimize the unhappiness linked to physical and mental illness. Another important part of energizing yourself is to attain adequate rest. Happy people invest time in revitalizing sleep and solitude.

9. Satisfy Your Most Important Values

Based on a survey of more than 6,000 individuals, social psychologist Steven Reiss concluded that people cannot find lasting happiness by aiming to have more fun or seeking pleasure. Instead, you have to satisfy your basic values or desires and take happiness in passing. To increase your value-based happiness, you

have to first identify your most important desires and then gear your life toward satisfying these values. Among these key values are curiosity, physical activity, honor, power, family, status, and romance.

10.Earn Enough Money to Do Meaningful Things and Avoid Misery

The role of money as a contributor to happiness is the subject of endless debate. Money cannot buy happiness, but having enough money to purchase the things and have the experiences that make you happy is important. Whether owning a tablet computer or a high-performance sports car would make you happy, they both require money—even though the amounts differ. It is widely acknowledged that helping less fortunate people

contributes to a person's happiness. A person who decides to purchase a holiday meal for 100 residents of a mission for the homeless would need discretionary money to execute this act of generosity. Feeding the homeless would in turn contribute to his or her happiness. However, the pursuit of money for its own sake is less likely to contribute to happiness.

11.Lead a Meaningful Life

Most of the principles previously stated, as well as the spheres-of-life happiness model, all point toward the conclusion that having a meaningful life is a major contributor to happiness. For example, if you are a greeting card designer and you perceive that you are contributing to improved personal relationships, you are likely to be happy.

Values

"Values" refer to the principles and beliefs that guide individuals or groups in their actions and decisions. They represent what is important to a person or society, influencing behavior, priorities, and interactions. Common values include honesty, integrity, respect, responsibility, and compassion. They can vary widely between cultures and individuals, shaping perspectives and lifestyles.

Examples of Values

Here are some examples of values that people often prioritize:

1. **Integrity**: Being honest and having strong moral principles.
2. **Respect**: Valuing others' rights, feelings, and opinions.
3. **Compassion**: Showing empathy and concern for others' suffering.
4. **Responsibility**: Being accountable for one's actions and obligations.
5. **Courage**: Facing challenges and fears with bravery.
6. **Innovation**: Valuing creativity and the pursuit of new ideas.
7. **Justice**: Advocating for fairness and equality.
8. **Collaboration**: Working well with others to achieve common goals.
9. **Sustainability**: Prioritizing environmental care and responsible resource use.
10. **Lifelong Learning**: Valuing personal growth and education throughout life.

These values can guide decision-making and shape personal and professional relationships

Characteristics of Values

Values are fundamental beliefs or ideals that guide behavior and decision-making. Here are some key characteristics of values:

1.Relatively Permanent

Values are often considered relatively permanent aspects of a person's identity. They form the foundation for beliefs, attitudes, and behaviors, influencing decisions and interactions over time. While they can evolve through experiences and new insights, the core values typically remain consistent throughout a person's life.

2.Differs from person to person

Values can vary widely between individuals based on factors like culture, upbringing, experiences, and personal beliefs. What one person sees as essential might not hold the same significance for someone else.

3.Differs from culture to culture

Values can vary widely between different cultures. Factors like history, religion, geography, and social norms all play a significant role in shaping what a culture values. For instance, some cultures might prioritize community and family ties, while others may emphasize individualism and personal achievement.

4.Creating norms

Values are fundamental beliefs that guide our behavior and decision-making. They provide the foundation for norms, which are the unwritten rules or expectations about how we should act in various situations.

5.Central to the core of a person

Values shape our beliefs, guide our decisions, and influence how we interact with others. They help define our identity and can be a source of motivation and purpose in life. When we align our actions with our core values, we often feel more fulfilled and authentic.

Source of Values

Sources of values are;

- Family: Family is a great source of values. A child leams his first value from his family.
- Friends & peers: Friends and peers play a vital role in achieving values.
- Community or society: As a part of society, a person leams values from society or different groups of society.
- School: As a learner, schools and teachers also play a very important role in introducing values.
- Media: Media such as – Print media and electronic media also play the role of increasing values in the minds of people.
- Relatives: Relative also helps to create values in the minds of people.
- Organization: Different organizations and institutions also play a vital role in creating value.

- Religion.
- History.
- Books.
- Others.

Types of values

Values refer to stable life goals that people have, reflecting on what is most important to them.

Rokeach divided values into two types.

The values important to people tend to affect their decisions, how they perceive their environment, and their actual behaviors.

There are two types of values are

1.Terminal Values.
2.Instrumental Values.

Terminal Values

- Terminal Values are most desirable to humans, and Instrumental values are views of how human desires should be achieved.

- These are values that we think are most important or desirable.

- Terminal Values refer to desirable end-states of existence, the goals a person would like to achieve during his or her lifetime.

- They include happiness, self-respect, recognition, inner harmony, leading a prosperous life, and professional excellence.

Instrumental Values

- Instrumental values deal with views on acceptable modes of conductor means of achieving the terminal values.

- These include being honest, sincere, ethical, and ambitious. These values are more focused on personality traits and character.

- There are many typologies of values. One of the most established surveys to assess individual values is the Rokeach Value Survey.

This survey lists 18 terminal and 18 instrumental values in alphabetical order. They are given below:

Terminal Values	Instrumental Values
A comfortable life (a prosperous life)	Ambitious (hardworking)
An exciting life (a stimulating, active life)	Broadminded (open-minded)
A sense of accomplishment (lasting contribution)	Capable (competent, efficient)
A world of peace (free of war and conflict)	Cheerful (lighthearted, joyful)
A world of beauty (the beauty of nature and the arts)	Clean (neat, tidy)
Equality (brotherhood, equal opportunity for all)	Courageous (standing up for your beliefs)
Family security (taking care of loved ones)	Forgiving (willing to pardon)
Freedom (independence, free choice)	Helpful (working for the welfare of others)
Happiness (contentedness)	Honest (sincere, truthful)
Inner harmony (freedom from inner conflict)	Imaginative (daring, creative)
Mature love (sexual and spiritual intimacy)	Independent (self-reliant, self-sufficient)
National security (protection from attack)	Intellectual (intelligent, reflective)
Pleasure (an enjoyable, leisurely life)	Logical (consistent, rational)
Salvation (saved, eternal)	Loving (affectionate, tender)
Self-respect(self-esteem)	Obedient (dutiful, respectful)
Social recognition (respect, admiration)	Polite (courteous, well-mannered)
A true friend (close companionship)	Responsible (dependable, reliable)
Wisdom (a mature understanding of life)	Self-controlled (restrained, self-disciplined)

Ethics

Ethics can be defined as a set of principles that helps in segregating fair from unfair. In other words, it is a branch of philosophy that deals with standards for right and wrong behaviour of individuals.

Importance of Ethics

Ethics play a crucial role in guiding behavior, decision-making, and interactions in both personal and professional contexts. Here are some key reasons why ethics are important:

1. People are motivated by both self-interest and moral commitments.

A major justification for behaving ethically on the job is to recognize that people are motivated by both self-interest and moral commitments. Most people want to maximize gain for themselves. At the same time, most people are to do something morallyright. As one of many examples, vast numbers of people donate money to charity, although keeping that amount of money for themselves would provide more personal gain.

2. A good ethical reputation can enhance business

Corporate ethics are a major component of ethical behavior for workers. Many business executives want employees to behave ethically because a good reputation can enhance business. A favorable corporate reputation may enable firms to charge premium prices and attract better job applicants. A favorable reputation also helps attract investors, including mutual fund managers whose primary responsibility is to purchase stock in companies. Certain mutual funds, for example, invest only in companies that are environmentally friendly. Managers want employees to behave ethically because unethical behavior—for example, employee theft, lost production time, and lawsuits— is costly.

3. Many unethical acts are illegal

Behaving ethically is also important because many unethical acts are also illegal and can lead to financial loss and imprisonment. A company that knowingly allows workers to engage in unsafe practices might be fined, and the executives may be held personally liable. Furthermore, unsafe practices can kill people. Low ethics have also resulted in financial hardship for employees as company executives raid pension funds of other companies they purchase, sharply reducing or eliminating the retirement funds of many workers.

4. High ethics increases the quality of work life because it provides guidelines for acceptable behavior

A subtle reason for behaving ethically is that high ethics increases the quality of work life. Ethics provides a set of guidelines that specify what makes for acceptable behavior. Being ethical will point you toward actions that make life more satisfying for work associates. A company code of ethics specifies what constitutes ethical versus unethical behavior. When employees follow this code, the quality of work life improves.

Several sample clauses from corporate (or company) ethical codes are as follows:

- Demonstrate courtesy, respect, honesty, and fairness.
- Do not use abusive language.
- Do not bring firearms, knives, or illegal drugs to work.
- Do not offer bribes.
- Maintain confidentiality of records.
- Do not harass (sexually, racially, ethnically, or physically) subordinates, superiors, coworkers, customers, or suppliers.

Ethical Mistakes and violations

Certain ethical mistakes, including illegal actions, recur in the workplace. Familiarizing yourself with these mistakes and violations can be helpful in monitoring your own behavior. Here we describe a number of common ethical problems faced by business executives as well as workers at lower job levels.

1.Illegally Copying Software

A rampant ethical problem is whether to illegally copy computer software including software downloaded from the cloud. According to Apple Inc., the annual loss to piracy is more than $11 billion.The illegal copying of software deprives software developers of profits they deserve for having produced the software. Such pirating also leads to the loss of potential jobs for many software developers because the companies that produce the software have less revenue.

2.Treating People Unfairly

Being fair to people means equity, reciprocity, and impartiality. Fairness involves the issue of giving people equal rewards for accomplishing equal amounts of work. The goal of human resource legislation is to make decisions about people based on their qualifications and performance—not on the basis of demographic factors such as sex, race, or age. A fair working environment is where performance is the only factor that counts (equity). Employer–employee expectations must be understood and met (reciprocity). Prejudice and bias must be eliminated (impartiality).

3.Sexual Harassment

Sexual harassment is a source of conflict and an illegal act. Sexual harassment is also an ethical issue because it is morally wrong and unfair. All acts of sexual harassment flunk an ethics test. Before sexually harassing another person, the potential harasser should ask, “Would I want a loved one to be treated this way?”

4.Conflict of interest

Part of being ethical is making business judgments only on the basis of the merits or facts in a situation. Imagine that you are a supervisor who is romantically involved with a worker within the group. When it comes time to assign raises, it will be difficult for you to be objective. A conflict of interest occurs when your judgment or objectivity is compromised. Conflicts of interest often take place in the sales end of business. If a company representative accepts a large gift from a sales representative, it may be difficult to make objective judgments about buying from the representative. Yet being taken to dinner by a vendor would not ordinarily cloud one’s judgment. Another common example of a conflict of interest is making a hiring decision about a friend who badly needs a job but is not well qualified for the position.

5.Divulging confidential information

An ethical person can be trusted not to divulge confidential information unless the welfare of others is at stake. Suppose a coworker tells you in confidence that she is upset with the company and therefore is looking for another job. Behaving ethically, you do not pass this information along to your supervisor, even though it would help your supervisor plan for a replacement. Now suppose the scenario changes slightly. Your coworker tells you she is looking for another job because she is upset. She tells you she is so upset that

she plans to destroy company computer files on her last day. If your friend does find another job, you might warn the company about her contemplated activities.

6.Misrepresentation of employment history

Many people distort in a positive direction information about their employment history on their job résumé, on their job application form, and during the interview. Distortion, or lying, of this type is considered unethical and can lead to immediate dismissal if discovered.

7.Ethical violations with computers and information technology

As computers have dominated the workplace, many ethical issues have arisen in addition to pirating software. One ethical dilemma that surfaces frequently is the fairness of tracking the websites a person visits and those from which he or she buys. Should this information be sold, like a mailing list? (Sometimes this tracking is harmless and humorous. A human relations professor was searching the Internet for articles about the Proactive personality. Soon he would regularly see advertisements for the acne medicationProactiv when he visited websites.) Another issue is the fairness of having an employee work at a keyboard for sixty hours in one week when such behavior frequently leads to repetitive-motion disorder. And is it ethical for workers to spend doing online shopping and placing bets online during the working day?

8. Causing Problems in Order to Take Credit for Fixing Them

A longstanding workplace issue involves employees who quietly cause problems so they can later take the credit for the problem's resolution.The advantage derived from fixing problems is that such behavior is considered quite valuable by most employers. The problem repaired might be fictitious, or simply exaggerated. For example, a service manager at an automobile dealership pretended that many customers were complaining about the dimly lit waiting room. So he proceeded to improve the lighting and then told the owners of the dealership about how he had enhanced customer satisfaction.

9. Lying in Order to Look Good

Outright lying is a frequent form of unethical behavior. The most general purposes of lying are to look good and to protect oneself from punishment. Lies vary in intensity and seriousness, and this variation influences the extent of their ethical violation. Lying about how much profit a company made, for example, is much more serious than being untruthful about why one is late for work on a given day. Several studies have suggested that the average person tells one to two lies a day, and frequently at work. The fact that lying is frequent does not make it ethical.

10. Engaging in Unethical Behavior to Benefit the Company

A final ethical mistake or violation concerns whether to engage in unethical behavior in order to help the company. This type of dilemma also contributes to unethical behavior in the workplace. Employees will be tempted to engage in unethical acts in order to benefit the company, in such ways as the following: (a) "cooking" numbers to boost the prediction of financial analysts' projections and stock values; (b) withholding information about the hazards of a pharmaceutical product; (c) neglecting to give customers correct change when the amount is small, such as a quarter.

Two studies found that workers were more likely to engage in unethical behavior when they identify with their employer and at the same time expect they will be rewarded for such behavior. An example would be receiving a favorable performance for benefiting the company with unethical behavior.

Guidelines for making ethical decisions

Following guidelines for ethical behavior is the heart of being ethical. Although many people behave ethically without studying ethical guidelines, they are usually following guidelines programmed into their minds early in life. The Golden Rule exemplifies a guideline taught by parents, grandparents, and kindergarten teachers. In this section, we approach ethical guidelines from six perspectives: (a) developing the right character traits, (b) using a guide to ethical decision making, (c) developing strong relationships with work associates, (d) using corporate ethics programs, (e) following an ethical role model in the company, (f) following an applicable code of professional conduct, and (g) blowing the whistle on highly unethical and illegal conduct.

1.Developing the Right Character Traits

Character traits develop early in life, yet with determination and self-discipline, many people can modify old traits or develop new ones. A character trait is an enduring characteristic of a person that is related to consistent moral and ethical behavior. For example, if a person has the character trait of untruthfulness, he or she will lie in many situations. Conversely, the character trait of honesty leads to behaving honestly in most situations. A focus on character is considered important also because many social commentators and academic people are concerned that there is a decline in the development of character. The decline has contributed to such problems as a lowered sense of duty and personal integrity.

2.Using a Guide to Ethical Decision Making

A powerful strategy for behaving ethically is to follow a guide for ethical decision making. Such a guide for making contemplated decisions includes testing their ethics. Ethical screening refers to running a contemplated decision or action through an ethics test. Such screening makes the most sense when the contemplated action or decision is not clearly ethical or unethical. If a sales representative were to take a favorite customer to KFC for lunch, an ethical screen would not be necessary. Nobody would interpret a bucket of chicken to be a serious bribe. Assume, instead, that the sales rep offered to give the customer an under-the-table gift of $1,000 for placing a large order with the rep’s firm. The sales representative’s behavior would be so blatantly unethical that conducting an ethical screen would be unnecessary.

3. Developing Strong Relationships with Work Associates

A provocative explanation of the causes of unethical behavior emphasizes the strength of relationships among people. Assume that two people have close professional ties to each other, such as having worked together for a long time or knowing each other both on and off the job. As a consequence, they are likely to

behave ethically toward one another on the job. In contrast, if a weak professional relationship exists between two individuals, either party is more likely to engage in unethical behavior. The owner of an auto service center is more likely to behave unethically toward a stranger passing through town than toward a long-time customer. The opportunity for unethical behavior between strangers is often minimized because individuals typically do not trust strangers with sensitive information or valuables.

4. Using Corporate Ethics Programs

Many organizations have various programs and procedures for promoting ethical behavior. Among them are committees that monitor ethical behavior, training programs in ethics, and vehicles for reporting ethical violations. The presence of these programs is designed to create an atmosphere in which unethical behavior is discouraged and reporting on unethical behavior is encouraged.

5. Following an Ethical Role Model in the Company

An important influence on your ethical behavior can be the behavior of other people whom you regard as ethical role models. The role model is not necessarily a top-level manager. He or she could be the purchasing agent who refuses to accept tickets to sporting events from vendors, the coworker who goes on a business trip and returns the part of the travel advance not spent, or the supervisor who tells workers the truth about company problems that might affect them.

6. Following an Applicable Code of Professional Conduct

Professional codes of conduct are prescribed for many occupational groups, including physicians, nurses, lawyers, paralegals, purchasing managers and agents, and real estate salespeople.

A useful ethical guide for members of these groups is to follow the code of conduct for their profession. If the profession or trade is licensed by the state or province, a worker can be punished for deviating from the code of conduct specified by the state. The code of conduct developed by the profession or trade is separate from the legal code but usually supports the same principles and practices. Some of these codes of conduct developed by the professional associations are fifty and sixty pages long, yet all are guided by the kind of ethical principles implied in the ethical decision-making guide described earlier. A representative principle would be to avoid conflicts of interest, such as a purchasing agent making a major purchase from a company he or she operates on the side.

7.Blowing the Whistle on Highly Unethical and Illegal Conduct

The ethics hotline mentioned above and used by many companies is one way of reporting on unethical and illegal behavior. At times, a person may feel obliged to report extreme acts of unethical and illegal conduct directly to higher management or to a government agency. A whistle-blower is an employee who reports wrongdoing in the organization to parties who can take action. Although whistle-blowing might be ethical, it represents a challenge for the whistle-blower. The majority of workers who observe unethical or illegal behavior remain silent. More than one-half the time, the pleas of whistle-blowers are ignored.

Problem Solving

Problem solving occurs when you try to remove an obstacle that is blocking a path you want to take or when you try to close the gap between what exists and what you want to exist.

Factors influencing problem solving

Many personal characteristics influence the type of problem solver and decision maker you are or are capable of becoming. Fortunately, some personal characteristics that influence your decision-making ability can be improved through conscious effort. For instance, if you make bad decisions because you do not concentrate on the details of the problem, you can gradually learn to concentrate better. Most of the personal characteristics described next can be strengthened through the appropriate education, training, and selfdiscipline.

1.Cognitive Intelligence, Education, and Experience

In general, if you are intelligent, well educated, and well experienced, you will make better decisions than people without these attributes. (The term cognitive intelligence refers to the intellectual, or traditional, type of intelligence that is necessary for such tasks as solving math problems and conjugating verbs.) Cognitive intelligence helps because, by definition, intelligence denotes the ability to solve problems. Education improves the problem-solving and decision-making process because it gives you a background of principles and facts on which to rely. Experience facilitates decision making because good decisions tend to be made by people who have already faced similar situations in the past.

2.Emotional Intelligence

Being able to deal effectively with your feelings and emotions and those of others can help you make better decisions. A worker with high emotional intelligence would be able to engage in such behaviors as sizing up people, pleasing others, and influencing them.

3.Flexibility versus Rigidity

Some people are successful problem solvers and decision makers because they approach every problem with a fresh outlook. They are able to avoid developing rigid viewpoints. Flexible thinking enables the problem solver to think of original—and therefore creative— alternative solutions to solving a problem. Another perspective on the same issue is that being open-minded helps a person solve problems well. In recent years, several major retailers have become more flexible in their thinking about inner cities as profitable locations for their stores.

4. Intuition

Effective decision makers do not rely on careful analysis alone. Instead, they also use their intuition, an experience-based way of knowing or reasoning in which weighing and balancing of evidence are done automatically. Judgments and decisions reached through intuition are rapid, and they are largely unconscious; we are not completely aware of how we reached the decision. Intuition appears to be composed of the interplay between knowing (intuition-as-expertise) and sensing (intuition-as-feeling). The best use of intuition, therefore, involves both bringing past facts in mind to deal with the situation and a sudden emotional hunch at the same time.

5.Concentration

Mental concentration is an important contributor to making good decisions. Many people who solve problems poorly do so because they are too distracted to immerse themselves in the problem at hand. In contrast, effective problem solvers often achieve the flow experience, total absorption in their work. When flow occurs, things seem to go just right. The person feels alive and fully attentive to what he or she is doing. As a byproduct of the flow experience, a good solution to a problem may surface. If you fail to concentrate hard enough, you may overlook an important detail that could affect the outcome of the decision.

6. Decisiveness and Perfectionism

Some people are ill suited to solving problems and making decisions because they are fearful of committing themselves to any given course of action. “Gee, I’m not sure, what do you think?” is their typical response to a decision forced on them. If you are indecisive, this characteristic will have to be modified if you are to become successful in your field. A manager has to decide which person to hire. And a photographer has to decide which setting is best for the subject. The combination of being indecisive and a perfectionist can lead to procrastination. Also, being a procrastinator can make one indecisive. Perfectionism contributes to delayed decision making because the person keeps working on a project before deciding to submit it to somebody else.

7.Risk Taking and Thrill Seeking

The need for taking risks and seeking thrills is yet another personality characteristic that influences problem-solving skill. For some types of problems, the high-risk taker and thrill seeker is at an advantage. For example, an information technology specialist might have to engage in a risky manoeuvre to salvage data from a crashed hard drive. Risk taking and thrill seeking can also lead to poor problem solving and decision making, such as a merchandiser buying a huge inventory of a highly original fashion. The experienced decision maker needs to know when to take high risks and seek thrills and when to be more conservative.

8.Values of the Decision Maker

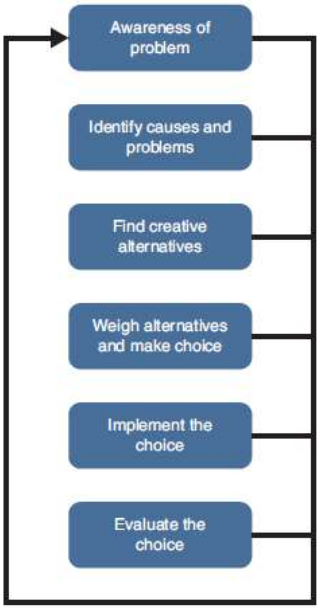
Values influence decision making at every step. The right values for the situation will improve problem solving and decision making, whereas the wrong values will lead to poor decisions. Ultimately, all decisions are based on values. A manager who places a high value on the well-being of employees tries to avoid alternatives that create hardships for workers. Another value that significantly influences problem solving and decision making is the pursuit of excellence. A worker who embraces the pursuit of excellence (and is therefore conscientious) will search for the high-quality alternative
solution.

Steps in Problem solving and Decision Making

Whatever complex problem you face, it is best to use the standard problem-solving and decision-making steps as a guide. These steps are similar to the systematic approach used in the scientific method and also contribute to critical thinking.

The following figure summarizes the steps involved in problem solving and decision making. It assumes that problem solving should take place in an orderly flow of steps. Paying attention to this model is important because deviating too far will often result in decision failure, such as not exploring enough options before choosing to pursue a course of action.

Although the problem-solving and decision-making steps appear logical, we emphasize again that people are frequently not entirely rational when making decisions. Emotions and personality traits can cloud decision making.



1.Be Aware of the Problem or Opportunity

Problem solving and decision making begin when somebody is aware that a problem exists. In most decision-making situations, problems are assigned to a person. At other times, people create their own problems to solve, or they find problems. After you are aware that a problem exists or have identified it, recognize that it may represent an important opportunity. If you are bothered enough by a problem facing your company, you might volunteer to be the person in charge of overcoming the problem.

2. Identify Causes of the Problem

The causes of problems should be diagnosed and clarified before any action is taken because they are not always what they seem to be on the surface. Some may be more complicated than suspected or may even be the wrong problem you need to solve in a particular situation.

3.Find Creative Alternatives

Creativity and imagination enter into problem solving and decision making. Successful decision makers have the ability to think of different alternatives. The person who pushes to find one more alternative to a problem is often the person who finds a breakthrough solution. The more alternatives you generate, the more likely you are to find a useful solution to your
problem.

4.Weigh Alternatives and Make the Choice

This stage refers simply to examining the pros and cons of the various alternatives in the previous stages and then making a choice. In a major decision, each alternative would have to be given serious consideration. The essence of decision making is selecting the right course of action to follow. You have to choose an alternative, even if it is not to go ahead with a new plan of action.

5.Implement the Choice

After you decide which course of action to take, you have to put the choice into effect. Some decisions are more difficult to implement than others. Decisions made by top management, for example, are sometimes so difficult to implement that they have to be reversed.

6.Evaluate the Choice

Decision making is not complete until the decision has been evaluated. Evaluation may take a considerable period of time because the results of your decision are not always immediately apparent.

Creativity

Creativity is the ability to develop good ideas that can be put into action.

Characteristics of creativity:

Creative workers tend to have different intellectual and personality characteristics from their less creative counterparts. Creative people are more mentally flexible than others, which allows them to overcome the traditional ways of looking at problems. The characteristics of creative workers can be grouped into three broad areas: knowledge, intellectual abilities, and personality.

1.Knowledge

Creative thinking requires a broad background of information, including facts and observations. Knowledge supplies the building blocks for generating and combining ideas. This is particularly true because, according to some experts, creativity always comes down to combining things in a new and different way.

2.Intellectual Abilities

Exceptionally high intelligence is not required to be creative, but creative people are good at generating alternative solutions to problems in a short period of time.

3. Personality

Creative people tend to have a positive self-image without being blindly self-confident. The self-confidence associated with worker creativity has been labelled creative self-efficacy, the belief that one has the knowledge and skills to produce creative outcomes. Creative self-efficacy is therefore a key psychological mechanism that supports solving problems
creatively.

The Conditions Necessary for Creativity

Creativity is not simply a random occurrence. Well-known creativity researcher and professor of business administration at Harvard Business School, Teresa M. Amabile, summarized twenty-two years of her research about creativity in the workplace. Her findings are also supported by others. Creativity takes place when three components come together: ***expertise, creative thinking skills, and the right type of motivation.***

1. Expertise refers to the necessary knowledge to put facts together. The more ideas floating around in your head, the more likely you are to combine them in some useful way, as already described.

2. Creative thinking skills refers to how flexibly and imaginatively individuals approach problems. If you know how to keep digging for alternatives and to avoid getting stuck in the status quo, your chances of being

creative multiply. Along these same lines, you are much more likely to be creative if you are intentionally seeking ideas, such as always being on the lookout for ways to save money.

3. The right type of motivation is the third essential ingredient for creative thought. A fascination with or passion for the task is much more important than searching for external rewards. Passion for the task and high intrinsic motivation contribute to a total absorption in the work and intense concentration, resulting in the flow experience.

In addition to the internal conditions that foster creativity, five factors outside the person are key:

1.An environmental need must stimulate the setting of a goal.

This is another way of saying, "Necessity is the mother of invention." For example, over a decade ago, independent hardware stores were faced with the challenge of large chains, such as Home Depot and Lowe's, driving them out of business. Many of these independent stores survived by forming buying alliances with each other so that they could purchase inventory in larger quantities—and therefore at lower prices. The independents also emphasize doing home repairs, such as fixing ripped screens and broken windows.

2.Another condition that fosters creativity is enough conflict and tension to put people on edge.

The conflicts should be about ideas, not personality conflicts and name-calling. For example, a group member should be given time to defend his or her work, and then the ideas should be sharply criticized by the other group members.

3.Another external factor for creativity is encouragement, including a permissive atmosphere that welcomes new ideas.

A manager or team leader who encourages imagination and original thinking and does not punish people for making honest mistakes is likely to receive creative ideas from people. W. L. Gore is often cited among the world's most innovative companies. You may be familiar with their waterproof fabrics and guitar strings. The cornerstone of Gore's innovative culture has been a permissive atmosphere.

4.Humor is a key environmental condition for enhancing creativity

Humor has always been linked to creativity. Humor gets the creative juices flowing, and effective humor requires creativity. Thomas Edison started every workday with a joke-telling session. Mike Vance, chair of the Creative Thinking Association of America, says, "Humor is unmasking the hypocritical. What makes us laugh often is seeing how things are screwed up—then sometimes seeing how we can fix them. Whenever I go into a company and don't hear much laughter, I know it's not a creative place."

5.A positive mood often contributes to creativity

Many people are at their creative problem solving best, when in a good mood, but the relationship between mood and creativity is not so clear-cut.

Methods for improving creativity

Because of the importance of creative problem solving, many techniques have been developed to improve creativity. The goal of these experiences is to think like a creative problem solver. Such a person lets his or her imagination wander. He or she ventures beyond the constraints that limit most people. The result of thinking more creatively is to bring something new into existence.

1.Believe That You Can Be Creative

As implied by creative self-efficacy, a starting point in increasing your creativity is to believe that you can. Acknowledge that you can solve problems with more imagination if you approach them with a different mindset. You can work up the confidence to solve a major problem creatively if you start small.

2.Concentrate Intensely on the Task at Hand

The ability to concentrate was mentioned earlier as a characteristic that contributes to effective problem solving in general. The ability to eliminate distractions also contributes mightily to generating new ideas. At times, we think we are thinking intently about our problem, yet in reality, we may be thinking about something that interferes with creativity. Among the office distractions that interfere with concentration are phone calls, a computer beep informing you of an incoming message, a person in the next cubicle talking loudly on the phone, and a friendly hello from a work associate walking past your cubicle. All the methods that follow for creativity enhancement require concentration.

3.Overcome Traditional Mental Sets

An important consequence of becoming more intellectually flexible is that you can overcome a traditional mental set, a fixed way of thinking about objects and activities. Overcoming traditional mental sets is important because the major block to creativity is to perceive things in a traditional way.

4.Conduct Brainstorming and Brainwriting Sessions

The best-known method of improving creativity is brainstorming, a technique by which group members think of multiple solutions to a problem. Using brainstorming, a group of six people might sit around a table generating new ideas for a product. During the idea generating part of brainstorming, potential solutions are not criticized or evaluated in any

way. In this way, spontaneity is encouraged. Brainstorming continues as a standard procedure for producing creative ideas in all types of organizations. If you engage in brainstorming on the job or in your personal life, you will be both solving a real problem and enhancing your creative thinking skills at the same time.

5.Establish Idea Quotas for Yourself

To enhance creativity, many companies assign idea quotas to workers. For example, workers might be instructed to bring one good idea for earning or saving money to every meeting. Establishing idea quotas is similar to brainwriting with a goal in mind. An easy way of getting started is to establish a monthly minimum quota of one creative idea to improve your personal.

6.Engage in Multicultural Experiences

An analysis of many studies supports the assumption that multicultural experience fosters creativity. Multicultural experience in this context refers to all direct and indirect experiences of encountering or

interacting with people from foreign cultures. This definition is helpful because it suggests that travel to other countries is not the only way to
obtain multicultural experience. life and one to improve your job or school performance. Although this exercise might take only about five minutes of thinking each month, it could have a tremendous impact on your life.

7.Obtain Adequate Physical Exercise

Physical exercise plays an important role in preparing you for creative thinking. Physical movement stimulates the brain by bringing it more blood and oxygen. At the same time, the exercise may reduce stress that makes it difficult to concentrate enough to think creatively. Exercise also enhances activity in the frontal lobe, the region of the brain involved in abstract reasoning and attention. Participating in physical activity may also foster creativity because many flashes of insight occur while engaged in leisure pursuits.

8.Solicit Feedback on Your Performance

An effective way of enhancing creativity on the job is to seek feedback on your performance from both your manager and your coworkers. Even if you are not asking for feedback on creative suggestions exclusively, the feedback process is likely to sharpen your imagination. An example of a feedback-seeking question would be “What did you think of my suggestion for reducing energy costs by encouraging employees to bring sweaters to the office?” The feedback refines your thinking, helping you develop ideas that others perceive to be imaginative.

9.Try Creative Problem Solving When You Are Not at Your Best

Many people believe that your best time for creative thinking is when you are well rested, and many people believe the opposite to true. When you are very fatigued, your mind loses its filtering mechanisms, enabling you to think more loosely and let in unusual thoughts.

10.Play the Roles of Explorer, Artist, Judge, and Lawyer

A method for improving creativity has been proposed that incorporates many of the suggestions already made. The method calls for you to adopt four roles in your thinking.

1. Be an explorer. Speak to people in different fields and get ideas that you can use. For example, if you are a telecommunications specialist, speak to salespeople and manufacturing specialists.

2. Be an artist by stretching your imagination. Strive to spend about 5 percent of your day asking “what if” questions. For example, a sales manager at a fresh-fish distributor might ask, “What if some new research suggests that eating fish causes intestinal cancer in humans?” Also remember to challenge the commonly perceived rules in your field. Years ago, a supermarket executive at a discount grocer questioned why the supermarket should have to go to the expense of providing customers with bags. Today, several discount supermarkets require that customers have the choice of bringing their own bags or purchasing a bag at the store.

3. Know when to be a judge. After developing some wild ideas, at some point you have to evaluate them. Do not be so critical that you discourage your own imaginative thinking, but be critical enough to prevent attempting to implement weak ideas.

4. Achieve results by playing the role of a lawyer. Negotiate and find ways to implement your ideas within your field or place of work. The explorer, artist, and judge stages of creative thought might last only a short time toward developing a creative idea. Yet you may spend months or even years getting your brainstorm implemented. For example, it took a long time for the developer of the robotic bricklayer to finally get the product manufactured and distributed on a large scale

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